

MANAGEMENT STATUS REPORT

YB Travel

Phase 1 Platform

A detailed explanation of what has been designed, implemented, secured, tested, and deployed - together with the remaining work and decisions required before full production use.

REPORT DATE	31 August 2026
CURRENT STATE	Production preview deployed and operational
LIVE REVIEW	http://2.24.28.178:4173
DEPLOYED REVISION	05b777a plus migration compatibility commit 105d4ad

Prepared for: YB Travel management
Purpose: status review, management alignment, and go-live planning

Executive summary

The management view: what the platform can do today and what still needs attention.

YB Travel now has a working Phase 1 operational platform that connects the main client-service workflow: employees can receive WhatsApp conversations, link them to clients, use AI to prepare an intake draft, review and approve the draft, create a real travel request, assign the request to eligible staff, track workflow and deadlines, and send a reviewed reply back to the client. The platform also includes configurable administration for users, staff capacity, booking fees, onboarding rules, required information, request types, urgency levels, message templates, AI-provider settings, and assignment routing.

The latest version is deployed to the YB Travel preview server. The web application and API are running, PostgreSQL is healthy, the WhatsApp session reconnected, production CORS and security headers are active, and a pre-deployment database backup was created. A legacy traveller relationship value was normalized during deployment so the complete schema migration could apply safely.

OPERATIONAL PREVIEW	CORE WORKFLOW	SECURITY BASELINE
Web, API, database, and WhatsApp are running on the server.	Inbox -> AI review -> request -> assignment -> client reply is implemented.	Authentication, throttling, access control, auditing, secure headers, secret rotation, and backup tooling are implemented.

Important management interpretation
Phase 1 is substantially implemented, but this is still a controlled production preview - not a final public launch. The remaining work is mainly production governance, external-provider decisions, configuration, dependency remediation, and completing the operational backends behind the current Bookings, Tickets, and Reports UI foundations.

Status at a glance

Area	Status	Management meaning
Client service workflow	IMPLEMENTED	Usable end-to-end with required human review before AI drafts create records or send messages.
Administration and configuration	IMPLEMENTED	Core Phase 1 rules can be maintained without code changes.
Production preview	LIVE	Deployed and technically healthy on the preview server.
AI provider on server	CONFIGURATION NEEDED	Encryption is ready, but the production OpenAI key must be entered in Setup before server-side AI analysis can run.
Full go-live	NOT YET APPROVED	Domain/HTTPS, provider governance, dependency remediation, backup schedule, and final acceptance testing are still required.

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How the system works

A practical use case showing how a client request moves from WhatsApp to accountable staff action.

Example client message

Incoming WhatsApp request

"I need two round-trip tickets from JFK to Tel Aviv around September 20, returning after Sukkot. There are two passengers."

1

Receive and identify

The WhatsApp message arrives in the shared Inbox. The system keeps the provider message ID, conversation, sender number, received time, and client linkage. Duplicate inbound provider messages are blocked at database level.

2

Prepare AI draft

The configured OpenAI provider classifies the request, extracts trip information, identifies missing details, estimates confidence, and proposes a client reply. The AI does not send anything and does not create a request automatically.

3

Employee review

An authorized employee reviews and edits request type, urgency, summary, origin, destination, dates, passenger count, missing information, and the proposed reply. Larger editable fields support practical review.

4

Create request

After explicit approval, the system creates a real request with request number, client, type, status, urgency, source, received time, deadlines, original conversation linkage, and audit history.

5

Assign staff

Administrators or intake staff choose an eligible employee. Travel agents can claim an unassigned request for themselves. The system records who assigned it, when, why, and the routing recommendation.

6

Work and communicate

The assigned employee sees the request in their queue, reviews the saved proposed answer, edits if needed, and deliberately sends it to the linked client. Delivery attempts, provider results, failures, and retries are tracked.

7

Monitor and audit

Deadlines, waiting-on status, assignment notifications, request history, AI usage, costs, sensitive-data access, and communication activity remain visible for follow-up and management review.

Control principle

AI assists with understanding and drafting. A human employee remains responsible for approving the request, assignment, client response, and any external action.

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Completed capabilities

The major business functions delivered so far.

Capability	What is available now
Secure access	Login, JWT sessions, role checks, immediate deactivation enforcement, login throttling, timed lockouts, restricted CORS, security headers.
Employees	Create staff with name, email, phone, one or more roles, availability, capacity, timezone, working hours, working days, and request qualifications. Open detailed employee profiles and workload history.
Clients	Create, search, open, and edit real clients; support individual, household, and company records; protect against duplicate phone records; preserve WhatsApp linkage.
Travellers	Create and open traveller profiles, link travellers to one or more clients, maintain relationship types, and audit access to passport details.
WhatsApp Inbox	Persist conversations and messages, show contact/group names, search conversations, start a conversation by phone number, preserve paired sessions, and reconnect safely.
AI Draft Intake	Classify inbound requests, extract travel details, show confidence and missing information, prepare an editable suggested reply, require review, and create an approved request.
Requests	Create and open real requests, search all requests, view every request from a conversation, maintain configurable type/status/urgency, calculate deadlines, and show demo records separately.
Assignment	Assign/reassign eligible staff, self-claim unassigned work, calculate explainable routing recommendations, enforce capacity/availability, notify assignees, and retain complete assignment history.
Client replies	Review the saved proposed response on the request, edit it, send deliberately to the linked WhatsApp client, and audit the send without duplicating sensitive content.
Setup	Manage booking fees, onboarding stages, required information, request workflow, message templates, AI provider, assignment policy, users, roles, availability, and demo data.
AI usage control	Record every provider call, purpose, model, tokens, estimated USD cost, staff member, status, and error; show period filters and billing link.
Security and recovery	Provider-message deduplication, outbound delivery attempt history, safe retry rules, AI-secret rotation, encrypted backup/verify/restore tools, and sensitive-document access auditing.

Design improvement delivered

The Inbox and AI review experience was widened and the Missing Information and Suggested Reply fields were expanded to seven visible lines with vertical resizing. This directly addresses the earlier difficulty reviewing and editing AI-generated text.

Client and traveller management

The foundation for reliable service history, communication, and request ownership.

The original prototype contained mostly demonstration screens. The current platform now has real database-backed client and traveller records with dedicated list and detail views. Staff can create a client, search by name or phone, open the client profile, edit live details, and add or link travellers from the selected client. Demonstration records remain clearly controlled by an administrator and read-only, so training data cannot be mistaken for live business data.

Key safeguards

- Phone uniqueness prevents duplicate client records from splitting conversation history.
- Conversation-to-client linkage is persisted, so a WhatsApp thread stays attached to the correct client.
- A traveller can belong to more than one client account through a controlled relationship vocabulary.
- Passport information is excluded from broad list responses and is only exposed on an authorized detail request.
- Every passport-detail view creates an access-history record without copying the sensitive values into the audit log.
- Amharic was removed from the US desk language configuration; English, Hebrew, and Yiddish remain supported.

Management value

ONE CLIENT RECORD	CONNECTED TRAVELLERS	COMPLETE HISTORY
Fewer duplicates and clearer ownership of phone numbers and conversations.	Households, companies, and individuals can be represented without copying traveller profiles.	Requests, messages, assignments, and access events can be traced to the correct client.

Operational rule

Live records can be edited by authorized staff. Demonstration clients and travellers remain read-only and can be hidden before production use without deleting or changing live data.

05

WhatsApp and AI-assisted intake

How the platform improves response speed while keeping employees accountable.

The Inbox is no longer a pasted-message demo. It is connected to a persistent messaging layer with conversations, provider message IDs, client linkage, message history, delivery state, and live updates. The paired WhatsApp session survives application redeployment through a dedicated persistent volume and reconnected successfully after the latest deployment.

What AI does

- Determines the most likely request type and urgency.
- Builds a concise trip summary from unstructured client text.
- Extracts origin, destination, departure/return expressions, and passenger count.
- Identifies missing information and prepares a professional follow-up question.
- Records confidence, tokens, estimated cost, model, purpose, status, and employee context.

What AI does not do

- It does not send a message automatically.
- It does not create a request until an employee approves the draft.
- It does not independently decide final deadlines, assignment, ticketing, or payment actions.
- It does not replace the employee's responsibility to confirm ambiguous dates such as 'next Friday' or 'after Sukkot'.

Production configuration required

The server now has a protected encryption key for AI credentials, but no production OpenAI provider record existed before deployment. An administrator must open Setup -> AI Provider, enter the production API key, enable the provider, and run the connection test before server-side AI intake will work.

Messaging reliability

Risk	Implemented protection
Duplicate inbound message	Database-enforced uniqueness on provider message IDs prevents creating the same message twice.
Confirmed send failure	Delivery attempt and failure details are stored; authorized staff can perform an audited manual retry.
Unknown delivery result	The platform avoids unsafe automatic resend when delivery is ambiguous, reducing the risk of duplicate client messages.
Lost WhatsApp pairing	Authentication files are stored in a persistent server volume and preserved during redeployment.

Request workflow, deadlines, and assignment

Turning a message into structured work with ownership, priorities, and traceability.

A real request is a business record, not merely an AI summary. It stores a request number, source conversation, client, request type, workflow status, urgency, received time, response due time, service due time, trip summary, ownership, and audit history. The Requests screen includes an All Requests section, live search, unassigned and assigned-to-me queues, and deep links to each request profile.

Date and deadline logic

The platform separates client travel dates from operational deadlines. AI can extract phrases such as 'next Friday', but the employee must confirm ambiguous dates. Response and service deadlines come from configured request-type and urgency rules. When travel is close, the workflow can surface higher risk and recommend faster service; the system should never silently treat the departure date itself as the service deadline.

Assignment model

Control	How it works
Eligibility	Active role, availability, working schedule, request qualification, and capacity are evaluated.
Routing	Preferred representative, secondary representative, client continuity, eligible team pool, and supervisor escalation are configurable.
Human control	Administrators and intake staff assign or reassign. A travel agent may claim an unassigned request for themselves.
Separation of concerns	Assignment state is separate from the operational workflow stage, so ownership changes do not misrepresent service progress.
Audit	Every real assignment records the actor, selected staff member, time, routing level, explanation, recommendation snapshot, and before/after state.
Notification	The new owner receives a private in-app notification that opens the exact request and can be marked read.

Management benefit
Every live request can now answer four questions: What does the client need? When must we respond? Who owns the work? What changed, and who changed it?

Administration and configurable business rules

The parts of Phase 1 that management can change without requesting a code change.

Setup area	Business control
Users and roles	Create employees, assign multiple roles, add WhatsApp phone numbers, activate/deactivate accounts, and review capability explanations.
Availability and capacity	Set availability, normal and urgent capacity, timezone, working hours/days, and request-type qualifications.
Booking fees	Maintain fee groups, currency, amount, per-passenger/per-booking behavior, passenger-category rules, and active state.
Onboarding	Maintain ordered onboarding stages, completion stage, review gate, milestone task role, priority, and expected duration.
Required information	Define required client, traveller, and request fields and the review requirement for each field.
Request workflow	Maintain approved request types, statuses, urgency levels, response targets, and service targets.
Message templates	Maintain approved WhatsApp templates by purpose and supported language. Current supported desk languages: English, Hebrew, Yiddish.
Assignment routing	Control routing order, team selection strategy, continuity, fallback timing, eligible roles, and escalation roles.
AI provider	Store an encrypted OpenAI API key, choose the model, enable/disable the provider, run a connection test, rotate encryption, and view usage.
Demo data	Show or hide read-only sample clients and travellers without changing live records.

Current WhatsApp group rule

Managed group creation currently links the group to both a client and a saved request, automatically selecting the newest request or guiding the user to create one. A later discussion recommended making the request optional for general client groups, but that policy change has not yet been approved or implemented.

Security, audit, and recovery

Controls added to reduce operational and data-protection risk.

Control area	Delivered protection
Brute-force protection	Persistent email-plus-IP throttling, failure windows, timed lockouts, and automatic cleanup.
Account deactivation	Current database status is re-checked; deactivated employees lose access immediately rather than waiting for token expiry.
Authorization	Role guards protect administrative, assignment, messaging, and sensitive-data operations.
HTTP protection	Content Security Policy, frame denial, content-type protection, referrer policy, permissions policy, cache prevention, and restricted CORS.
Sensitive data	Passport details are redacted from lists; detail access is audited without copying the data into logs.
Messaging integrity	Provider message IDs prevent duplicates; outbound delivery attempts, failures, retries, and ambiguous states are recorded.
Secret rotation	JWT grace-key rotation and AI-credential re-encryption under a new primary key are supported.
Backup and restore	Encrypted backup, verification, guarded restore, PostgreSQL tooling, operating procedures, and a tested restore drill are included.
Regression testing	Database-backed tests cover throttling, deactivation, duplicate prevention, delivery failures, passport redaction/access, headers, and encrypted-file integrity.

Latest production verification

- API health endpoint returned status ok and database connected.
- Web application returned HTTP 200.
- Production CORS accepted only the deployed web origin used in the verification.
- Security response headers were visible on the live API.
- PostgreSQL, API, and web containers remained running after migration.
- A custom-format PostgreSQL backup was created before deployment and confirmed present afterward.

Security limitation still open
The current public preview uses an IP address over HTTP. A real domain, TLS certificate, reverse proxy, and HTTPS-only policy are required before treating the environment as a final production endpoint.

Deployment status and evidence

What was deployed, how it was protected, and what was verified.

Item	Verified state
Environment	YB Travel production preview server
Web URL	http://2.24.28.178:4173
API	Port 4001; health status ok; PostgreSQL connected
Database	PostgreSQL 17 container; persistent volume; healthy
Application revision	05b777a - Complete YB Travel Phase 1 workflows and security
Deployment compatibility	105d4ad - Normalize legacy traveller relationships during migration
Backup	/srv/yb-travel/backups/predeploy-20260831T132131Z.dump
Persistent WhatsApp state	Preserved in the yb_travel_baileys_auth Docker volume
Final services	yb-travel-web, yb-travel-api, yb-travel-postgres - all running

Deployment sequence

- Recovered the previously supplied server credential without printing it in chat or logs.
- Confirmed the existing stack and created a pre-deployment database backup.
- Added protected production CORS, AI-secret encryption, and backup-encryption settings without exposing values.
- Built the API and web locally with the supported Node runtime, then built production Docker images on the server.
- Applied the idempotent database schema and normalized one legacy traveller relationship value from kid to child.
- Restarted the application containers while preserving database and WhatsApp volumes.
- Verified health, security headers, CORS, database schema, containers, and backup presence.
- Removed the temporary local credential file after deployment.

Source-control note

The deployment commits exist locally, but the GitHub push was blocked because the configured origin repository could not be independently verified as an approved destination. Management should confirm the official repository before the push is retried.

Fourteen-workstream delivery view

A management-oriented consolidation of the Phase 1 scope discussed and implemented across the project sessions.

#	Workstream	Status	Explanation
1	Platform foundation and deployment	LIVE PREVIEW	Monorepo, web, API, database, Docker deployment, health checks, and migration flow are operational.
2	Authentication, users, and roles	COMPLETE P1	Secure login, roles, capability explanations, phone registration, activation/deactivation, and employee profiles.
3	Employee availability and capacity	COMPLETE P1	Schedules, timezones, capacities, availability, qualifications, workload, and assignment use these values.
4	Client management	COMPLETE P1	Real create/search/open/edit, client types, duplicate-phone protection, WhatsApp linkage, and demo controls.
5	Traveller management	COMPLETE P1	Real traveller profiles, client links, relationship types, passport redaction, and access auditing.
6	WhatsApp Inbox	OPERATIONAL	Persistent messages, client linkage, contact names, new conversations, reconnect, duplicate prevention, and delivery tracking.
7	AI provider and usage	BUILT - CONFIGURE	Secure settings, connection test, secret rotation, token/cost history. Production API key entry remains required.
8	AI Draft Intake	BUILT - KEY NEEDED	Classification, extraction, missing information, draft reply, employee review, approval, and request creation.
9	Request workflow and deadlines	COMPLETE P1	Real requests, all/search views, statuses, types, urgency, response/service deadlines, and history.
10	Assignment and notifications	COMPLETE P1	Eligibility, capacity-aware routing, assignment/reassignment, self-claim, fallback, audit, and private notifications.
11	Booking fee configuration	COMPLETE P1	Fee groups, amount/currency, passenger/booking basis, categories, and active state are configurable.
12	Onboarding, required information, templates	COMPLETE P1	Editable onboarding stages, required fields, and approved multilingual message templates are available.
13	Managed WhatsApp groups	CURRENT RULE BUILT	Creation flow and request linkage are implemented; request-optional group policy remains a pending decision.
14	Bookings, tickets, and reports	FOUNDATION / DEMO	Navigation and UI foundations exist, but complete operational backends and external booking/ticketing integrations are not finished.

How to read this table

Complete P1 means the agreed Phase 1 business capability is implemented and tested in the application. It does not mean every future automation, integration, report, or production operating procedure is complete.

What is not complete

The remaining gaps are explicit so management can set realistic expectations.

Open item	What remains	Priority
Production OpenAI connection	Enter and test the production API key on the deployed server. Confirm the approved model and monthly budget/usage alerts.	High
Domain and HTTPS	Add the approved domain, TLS certificate, reverse proxy, HTTPS redirects, and final origin settings.	High
Official WhatsApp provider decision	The current integration uses Baileys, an unofficial WhatsApp library. Decide whether to continue with the controlled number or migrate to an official provider for final production.	High
Dependency remediation	The production image build reported 22 npm audit findings: 3 low, 13 moderate, and 6 high. Review direct/transitive packages, remediate safely, and regression-test before go-live.	High
Scheduled/offsite backups	Backup/verify/restore tooling exists and a manual backup was created. Add an automated schedule, retention policy, offsite copy, alerting, and recurring restore drill.	High
Bookings and ticketing backend	Complete operational booking/ticket records, issuance workflow, payment/PNR lifecycle, and any GDS or airline integration.	Medium
Management reporting backend	Replace demonstration report views with agreed KPIs, filters, exports, and trusted operational data definitions.	Medium
WhatsApp group policy	Approve whether general client groups may exist without a request and define when later request linkage becomes mandatory.	Medium
Repository confirmation and push	Confirm the official GitHub destination, then push commits 05b777a and 105d4ad and establish the normal deployment branch/release process.	Medium
Final acceptance and training	Complete role-by-role user acceptance testing, run a controlled pilot, document support ownership, and train staff before wider use.	High

Operational caution

The live preview contains actions that can contact clients or create WhatsApp groups. Reviewers should inspect drafts and configuration freely, but should not press Send to client or Create WhatsApp Group unless the external action is intentional.

Decisions requested from management

The choices that will unblock a controlled production launch.

#	Decision	Why it matters
1	Confirm the official GitHub repository	Approve the exact repository/branch that should receive the current commits.
2	Approve the production URL and HTTPS approach	Choose the domain and hosting/reverse-proxy responsibility.
3	Approve WhatsApp provider policy	Accept the current Baileys risk for the controlled number or fund migration to an official provider.
4	Approve AI operating policy	Confirm model, budget, monthly alert thresholds, allowed data, retention, and human-review requirement.
5	Approve service deadlines	Confirm response and service targets by request type and Normal/High/Urgent level.
6	Approve assignment policy	Confirm preferred/secondary continuity, team-pool strategy, capacity limits, fallback timing, and escalation roles.
7	Decide request-optional WhatsApp groups	Confirm whether general client groups may be created without a travel request.
8	Define Phase 2 priorities	Choose whether the next investment goes first to bookings/ticketing, official WhatsApp, reporting, payment/PNR, or additional automation.

Recommended management position

Proceed with a controlled pilot
Use a small group of trained employees and selected internal/test conversations. Complete AI-key configuration, HTTPS, dependency remediation, automated backups, and the final acceptance checklist before opening the platform to broader daily production traffic.

Recommended rollout plan

A practical sequence that protects client service while turning the preview into a managed production system.

Gate	Stage	Exit requirement	Owner
Gate 1	Management decisions	Confirm repository, domain/HTTPS, WhatsApp provider policy, AI policy, SLAs, assignment rules, and group-linkage rule.	Management
Gate 2	Production configuration	Enter/test OpenAI key, configure approved request deadlines, assignment policies, booking fees, templates, staff schedules, and capacities.	Administrator + Operations
Gate 3	Technical hardening	Resolve npm audit findings, enable HTTPS, automate encrypted backups, configure monitoring/alerts, and push source to the approved repository.	Technical owner
Gate 4	Role-based acceptance	Test administrator, offshore intake, and travel-agent workflows; verify permissions, assignment, notifications, messages, deadlines, and audits.	Business owners
Gate 5	Controlled pilot	Use selected staff and low-risk/test clients; review AI accuracy, response time, duplicate handling, delivery failures, and staff workload daily.	Operations
Gate 6	Go-live decision	Review pilot evidence, unresolved incidents, backup restore evidence, provider costs, and staff feedback before broader rollout.	Boss + Operations + Technical

Suggested management review path

- Open the live preview and sign in with an authorized management/administrator account.
- Review Setup to understand which business rules are configurable.
- Open Clients and Travellers to verify real records, detail pages, and linked travellers.
- Open Inbox and review an existing conversation and its Requests in this conversation section.
- Open a real request and review type, urgency, deadlines, assignment recommendation, audit history, and proposed client reply.
- Review AI usage and cost history after the production key is configured and a controlled test is performed.
- Do not send a live message or create an external group unless that action is part of an approved test.

Conclusion

What management can confidently say today.

YB Travel has moved from a visual prototype to a working, database-backed operational platform with secure employee access, real clients and travellers, a connected WhatsApp Inbox, AI-assisted intake under human control, real request creation, configurable deadlines, staff assignment, notifications, client replies, audit history, usage tracking, security controls, and deployment/recovery tooling.

The core Phase 1 service workflow is implemented and deployed. The appropriate next step is not unrestricted launch; it is a controlled pilot supported by clear management decisions, production configuration, HTTPS, dependency remediation, scheduled backups, and final role-based acceptance testing.

Bottom line

The system is ready for serious management review and controlled operational testing. It is not yet ready to be declared fully complete across bookings, ticketing, reporting, official-provider governance, and final production operations.

Prepared from verified project evidence

Sources reviewed: project CHANGELOG.md; current source tree; API modules and web routes; commits 05b777a and 105d4ad; the 31 August 2026 deployment verification; and the local YB Travel session record. This report intentionally distinguishes implemented Phase 1 capability from demo-only UI, pending policy decisions, and production-readiness work.